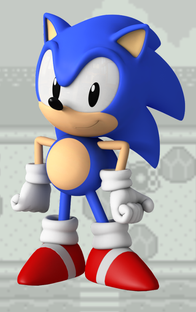
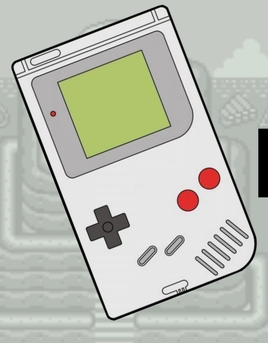
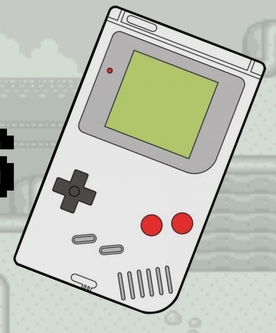
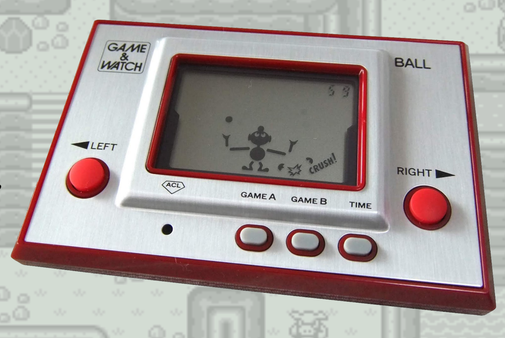
EVOLUTION OF HANDHELD GAMING



1979 MILTON BRADLEY MICROVISION

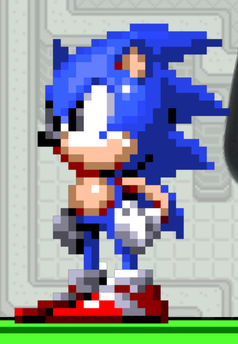
First cartridge based gaming unit. Used dial for gameplay. Processor was on games themselves; and screens suffered from screen rot.

1980 NINTENDO GAME & WATCH

Collection of games on each unit; basic left/right buttons.

1989 NINTENDO GAME BOY

Started the revolution of handheld games. Normalized D-Pad controls and true handheld gaming. Supported large gaming library.



2003 NINTENDO GAME BOY ADVANCE

Full color and backlit screen for Nintendo consoles. Foldable size was more portable and unique. Introduced rechargeable batteries

1998 NINTENDO GAME BOY COLOR

Introduced colors to Game Boy and provided a more engaging experience with creative programming.

1990 SEGA GAME GEAR

Introduced backlit and color gaming and was bridging console to handheld.

2004 NINTENDO DS

The DS introduced dual screens with a touch screen (controlled via stylus) and switched to SD like cards instead of cartridges. An OS on the platform added extra features over just games.

2004 SONY PLAYSTATION PORTABLE

The first successful migration of PlayStation into the mobile world. Included a familiar PS gaming feel and a large collection of games with more adult titles. Used UMD disk and supported media.

2011 SONY PSP VITA

Introduced dual joysticks (more like a real PS) and replaced UMD with SD card like games and downloads). Was final attempt at portable market for Sony.

2017 NINTENDO SWITCH

The Switch is probably the most unique handheld; being a full handheld and TV console in one. This allows Nintendo to have a foot in both markets without the need for multiple hardware. The unique controls and multiple playing methods allow for any gaming type

2013 NVIDIA SHIELD PORTABLE

This hybrid handheld plays full computer games by streaming from a computer to this screen running Android OS. Used a standard console controller